DRAFT

COM-006

Neighborhood Communication and Check-Ins

Build a voluntary neighbor network that relays verified information and checks on people without acting as an emergency authority.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Neighborhood messages are not official emergency instructions. Only an authorized public-safety agency can issue an official evacuation, shelter, or access instruction. Never delay calling 911, leaving danger, or following an official alert while waiting for a coordinator.

AGREE ON BOUNDARIES BEFORE AN EMERGENCY

Neighbors can

- Relay an official message with its issuer and time
- Ask whether help is requested
- Share firsthand observations, clearly labeled
- Report unmet needs through the proper channel
- Protect private household information

Neighbors must not

- Issue or cancel an evacuation order
- Enter a closed, burning, flooded, or unsafe area
- Self-deploy or impersonate responders
- Share rumors or sensitive medical details
- Promise rescue, transport, or radio coverage

USE A DISCIPLINED MESSAGE

1. **Label the source:** “Official message from [agency]” or “Neighbor observation—not an official instruction.”
2. **Add time and place.** State when and where the information applies.
3. **Repeat exactly.** Do not strengthen, soften, or interpret an official instruction.
4. **Name the next step.** Give the agency's source so recipients can verify updates themselves.
5. **Close the loop.** Mark whether the person received the message or requested assistance; pass needs to the appropriate service without broadcasting private details.

Neighborhood Communication and Check-Ins — continued

OUR VOLUNTARY CHECK-IN NETWORK

Area / household	Primary contact and method	Backup contact and method	Assistance requested?
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

Coordinator: _____ **Backup:** _____ **Review date:** _____

VERIFY LOCAL COMMUNICATION DETAILS BEFORE USE

Item	Verified entry	Responsible agency / owner	Verified by and date
Official alert system and enrollment URL	_____	_____	_____
Official information phone	_____	_____	_____
Neighborhood channel / group	_____	Neighborhood network	_____
Radio frequency / channel	_____	_____	_____
Assigned call sign(s)	_____	_____	_____

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

Required publication check: An authorized representative of the named agency must verify every official local entry. The neighborhood owner verifies coordination details. Blank, expired, secondhand, or unverified entries must not be published.

Agency representative and role: _____
Direct verification method: _____ **Date:** _____
Binder reviewer initials: _____

SOURCES

Sources: FEMA, “Community Emergency Response Team Basic Training Participant Manual”; Ready.gov, “Make a Plan.” Accessed September 25, 2026. This worksheet assigns no response authority and intentionally contains no unverified local operational details.